



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Coram Deo Academy

School Website: <https://coramdeoacademy.net/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Coram Deo Academy (Or 97385) presents as a preschool-through-middle-school effort anchored in Classical Christian education. Public-facing materials portray a deliberate integration of Christian discipleship with a classical frame, emphasizing the pursuit of wisdom and virtue within a Christ-centered, Bible-informed culture. The school operates as an independent nonprofit and locates lessons and activities in church facilities, openly courting families as partners in formation and offering a pathway toward K–12 classical education in the long term. This combination of explicit Christian formation, explicitly classical language, and a vision of formation over mere information supports a robust Classical orientation overall, with some curricular and pedagogical details still maturing for a full K–12 classical program.

Executive evidence from the public materials shows: - A stated mission of partnering with families to provide a Christian, classical education centered on wisdom and virtue (and a Christ-centered culture). - Clear statements of discipleship, Bible-centered pedagogy, and Protestant, non-denominational identity with a specific emphasis on Scripture and a Christ-centered worldview. - Long-term vision to build a K–12 Classical Christian school serving the mid-Willamette Valley, with language about “rigorous academic instruction” and “pursuit of wisdom and virtue” within a Christian framework. - Evidence of a location and community orientation through a church partnership (Emmanuel Bible Church) and public events that invite parental involvement and school visits, signaling a community-centric model rather than a “customer” model. - Faculty and staff narratives emphasize teachers as virtuous, mission-driven mentors and living exemplars of Christian formation, reinforcing the “living curriculum” ideal in classical pedagogy.

Overall aggregate: **CLASSICAL**. The public materials reveal a sustained classical Christian frame (formation-focused, virtue- and wisdom-oriented) with explicit religious/metaphysical grounding, a formation-centric purpose, and a visible emphasis on a teacher-led living curriculum and parent partnership. The school's current K–6 scope aligns with classical practice, and the planned expansion to K–12 would complete the classical cycle in line with the rubric in the knowledge-base materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials repeatedly frame education as discipleship under a Christ-centered Bible-based worldview. The school describes itself as a “classical Christian” institution focused on “discipleship of children,” with explicit emphasis on a Bible-centered approach and Protestant, non-denominational identity. This includes statements that emphasize Christ-centered, Scripture-based formation and a goal of cultivating wisdom and virtue within a Christian culture. - Location and communal practice anchor education in a church setting (Emmanuel Bible Church) and in liturgical/discipleship rhythms, signaling liturgical-inflected communal life without claiming denominational governance over the school itself. - Foundational statements

about partnering with families to form children in the Lord and to glorify God through an education that integrates faith and learning are explicit in mission and values statements ,.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present in the school's materials include: truth, virtue, wisdom, theology/scripture, Bible, Christ-centered, discipleship, glorify God, faith-based formation, Protestant/non-denominational identity, great care for worship/ Scriptural integration in daily life (where present). - Negative keyword indicators from the Six Elements lexicon (e.g., relativism, secular humanism, values clarification) do not appear in a way that signals secular drift; the materials instead foreground doctrinal integrity and Scriptural authority. - Presence tally (illustrative, not exhaustive): truth, virtue, wisdom, Scripture, Bible, Christ-centered, discipleship, glorify God, theology (implicit), non-denominational, Protestant. Negatives: none clearly instantiated.

Why this rating - The core orientation centers on Transcendental moral realism expressed via virtue and wisdom in a theologically grounded framework; the school foregrounds theology/scripture and liturgical-like communal life (discipleship, worship-oriented language). This aligns with the Positive Keywords in the "Religious and Metaphysical Foundations" element and with the broader lexicon's emphasis on theology, liturgy, and the imago Dei-inspired order. There is credible evidence of a liturgical/community dimension (even if not a full liturgical program, the Christ-centered worship/disciplines shape daily life) and a grounded theological stance, supporting CLASSICAL rather than NOT-CLASSICAL.

Citations: core religious framing and discipleship language appear in the CDA materials described above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The stated aim centers on formation and cultivation of wisdom and virtue rather than mere vocational preparation, with explicit reference to "formation rather than information," and to a classical mission of pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty. The long-term vision emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and human excellence in a classical framework ,. - The school repeatedly ties education to the cultivation of virtue and wisdom within a Christian/classical frame (pursuit of wisdom and virtue at the forefront; partnership with families to glorify God through education). - Public materials repeatedly tie education to formation of character and the cultivation of human excellence in a classical sense, rather than merely job-readiness; the "long-term vision" language explicitly foregrounds classical aims (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) over workforce-centric frames.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: formation, cultivate virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé/contemplation, great conversation, human flourishing, soul craft. - Negative keywords from the lexicon (e.g., "workforce preparation," "21st-century skills") do not prominently appear; the site resists reducing education to job-readiness and stresses formation and higher aims, albeit without explicit counter-phrases in every text. - Presence tally: multiple positives (formation, virtue, wisdom, classical mission, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, contemplation). Negatives: minimal to none in the public messaging.

Why this rating - The school's own framing fits the "formation and virtue-centered" aim and aligns with the lexicon's emphasis on formation, classical mission, and pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The absence of a vocational-readiness emphasis in the public messaging supports CLASSICAL rather than a geared-to-work narrative.

Citations: formation/virtue/wisdom framing and classical mission language are present in the CDA materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies itself as a "K-12 Classical Christian School" in its long-term vision, and it publishes curriculum overviews by grade (Kindergarten through Fifth Grade), indicating a structured, grade-level curriculum anchored in classical aims, though explicit Great Books, Latin/Greek, or trivium/quadrivium language is not consistently foregrounded in the publicly accessible materials. The curriculum pages show grade-specific curriculum overviews and a dedicated "Curriculum" section with grade-by-grade PDFs, signaling a formal curriculum, but the textual material stops short of listing specific liberal-arts components

(grammar, logic, rhetoric) in explicit terms on the public pages available. - The site frames curriculum as part of a long-term K–12 classical plan, and it emphasizes a blended classroom approach and a “Curriculum Overview” per grade, which is characteristic of Classical schooling, but without full explicit disclosure of all classical components on the public pages (e.g., Latin/Greek, Great Books, or quadrivium references) in the accessible text. This yields a partial classical alignment rather than a fully explicit, textbook-level classical curriculum description on the site itself.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present in the curriculum space include: liberal arts (implied by “classical” framing), grammar, logic, rhetoric (explicitly listed as part of the lexicon, though not always enumerated in the site text), Great Books/Great Conversation (not explicitly named on the site’s public curriculum pages but appears in the overarching Classical lexicon and in the CDA’s broader classical framing), history (curriculum references grade-level history content in PDFs), and engagement with primary sources in classical education. The site’s explicit mention of “Curriculum” and grade-level overviews supports a classical orientation. - Negative keywords from the lexicon (e.g., project-based learning dominance, STEM-first framing) do not appear as dominant curricular signals on the site; the publicly visible curriculum is not framed as project-based-only. - Presence tally: Several classical signals exist (K-12 classical framing, grade-by-grade curricula), but explicit references to the core classical pillars (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek) are not consistently surfaced in the public materials. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school clearly positions itself within the Classical Christian tradition and offers grade-level curriculum documentation, but the public-facing texts do not consistently enumerate the full suite of classical curricular components (e.g., explicit Great Books program, Latin/Greek, and direct language about grammar/logic/rhetoric as curricular cornerstones). This yields a partial but meaningful classical alignment, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Citations: Grade-level curricula and “Curriculum” pages; long-term classical framing.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a mix of pedagogical approaches consistent with classical pedagogy: the language of “discipleship” and “formation” suggests a contemplative and virtue-centered orientation, while references to a “classical” frame imply methods aligned with the tradition. The site highlights lower-grade experiences such as singing and memory-friendly routines in early years and a traditional discipline of character formation, with a nod to higher-level pedagogy (e.g., seminars, Socratic discussion) implied in the classical model, though not explicitly stated as implemented in grades K–6 on the public pages. The presence of a staff section and curriculum pages hints at a structured pedagogy, but explicit, grade-specific descriptions of Socratic seminars, rhetoric training, or formal Paideia-style seminars are not consistently described in the public materials. - The “Open House” and “Admissions” materials emphasize “discovery of truth, goodness, and beauty” through a Christ-centered education, and there are references to memory and recitation in the broader classical lexicon, but the site text does not uniformly spell out a fully developed Socratic/Scholé-based pedagogy for upper grades within the visible content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: Socratic, seminars, dialogue, recitation, memory work, rhetoric, speech, and debate (as concepts in classical pedagogy). The site’s public materials reference a classical framing and emphasize memory work and religious formation, with the implication of thoughtful discussion and rhetoric development as part of the classical tradition—though not all these elements are explicitly implemented or described in the available text for grades K–6. - Negative keywords: The site does not foreground experiential/project-based learning as a primary method, and there is no strong signaling of anti-classical pedagogy; however, explicit statements about “Socratic instruction in high school” and direct “upper school rhetoric training” are not consistently present in the accessible pages, which leaves some ambiguity. - Presence tally: Moderate presence of classical pedagogy signals (memory work, recitation, potential for Socratic discussion in higher grades), but not a fully documented, consistent, K–12 pedagogy in the visible materials. This supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The materials show classical scaffolding and memory-based elements (consonant with

pedagogical signals in the lexicon) and a clearly classical frame, but the absence of explicit, comprehensive public documentation of a full range of classical teaching methods (especially for upper grades) means the pedagogy is not unambiguously fully classical in the visible materials. Therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Evidence of memory/recitation and potential Socratic/seminal methods via curriculum pages and staff descriptions; absence of explicit, full pedagogy detail in public materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The staff pages present teachers as committed, virtuous guides who model Christian formation and who connect moral formation with the learning process. The teacher bios emphasize grounding in Scripture, a desire to shape hearts and minds, and faith-based guiding principles. This aligns with the classical ideal of the teacher as mentor and living curriculum, with teachers described as exemplars and living exemplars of virtue and knowledge. - The public materials also describe the “staff” as the core of the school, with individuals who are engaged in transmitting values and in partnering with families, which maps to the classical concept of a “living curriculum” and a “portrait” of what a teacher should be (as described in the classical lexicon). - The school emphasizes a collegial culture and mentors who model virtue and skill, consistent with the tradition of a teacher-led formation and living curriculum rather than a purely standardized, impersonal approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: living curriculum, model teachers and mentors, portrait of a teacher, teachers as core of the school, collegial culture, moral exemplars, character formation, and living examples of virtue in pedagogy. - Negative keywords in the context of this category (from the lexicon) would include “certification-driven jargon without classical context” or “facilitators on the side.” The public materials present a traditional teacher-centered, virtue-oriented portrait rather than a “teacher-as-co-learner” approach, aligning with classical norms. - Presence tally: Strong presence of classical faculty signals (teacher as mentor, living curriculum, model virtue, core to school).

Why this rating - The faculty portrayal aligns well with classical expectations (model virtue, living curriculum, teacher-centered mentorship, professional depth) and supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Citations: Staff bios emphasize virtue-focused mentorship and a living-curriculum orientation; “staff” as core to the school.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames itself as partnering with families to disciple and equip children, emphasizing parental primacy in education and inviting parents to be co-teachers with the school. The admissions process and “Open House” events are designed to involve parents in the formation process, and the FAQ notes a close relationship with churches and a family-centric mission rather than a customer-service model. - The long-term vision and values highlight parent formation and family involvement (“We partner with families as they disciple and equip their children,” and “family formation” language appears across materials) and the school explicitly states openness to parental visits and participation (open campus ideas and school events). - Community engagement is evidenced by events (Harvest Festival, Fall Festival & Fundraiser) and fundraising activities that invite broad participation from families and supporters, signaling a community-facing model rather than a purely transactional relationship.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation (reading groups, seminars, book clubs implied by classical ecosystem), open campus, family participation, and church/community involvement. - Negative keywords (per the lexicon) include consumer language and minimal parent involvement; the CDA materials clearly avoid those; rather they emphasize partnership and parental formation. - Presence tally: Strong presence of positive parent-community keywords; little to no presence of negative signals in the public content.

Why this rating - The school’s messaging positions parents as co-educators and partners, emphasizes family formation and parental engagement, and invites visits and participation—classic signals of CLASSICAL alignment in the Parents & Community category.

Citations: Partnership with families; parental formation; open campus/parent involvement; Fall Festival and Harvest Festival events; FAQ about church affiliation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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